

Libet took this to mean that the subjects in the “veto” experiment decided to flex at the target time, but were able to exercise conscious free will to veto this decision about 200ms before the action.

Is this good news for free will? Yes and No. Yes, because it appears to make room for conscious free will. No, because it gives conscious free will a disappointingly limited role to play.

In another paper, Libet described the situation as follows:

From Libet et. al., “The Neural Time-Factor in
Perception, Volition, and Free Will”



replies to
Libet

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the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
good?

“Assuming that one can extrapolate these results to volitional acts generally, they do not exclude a possible role for free will ... However, the potential role for free will would be constrained; it would be changed from being an initiator of the voluntary act to one only of controlling the outcome of the volitional process, after the individual becomes aware of an intention ... to act now.”

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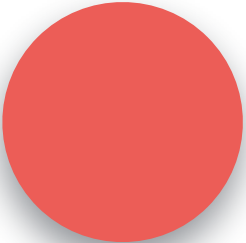
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voluntarily, they do not need a paid role

outcomes of the various individual processes, after the individual

would be considered; it would be argued from being a

beams are anti-aircraft

for free will. However, the potential for free will

'Assuring that our next steps to

initiating the voluntary activity

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free

will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

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the Libet experiments

